

The Pros & Cons Of Selling Your House To A Local Professional Home Buyer

Local professional home buyers—often called "Cash Buyers" or "Real Estate Investors"—offer an alternative. At **Spencer Buys Houses**, the goal is to provide a "win-win" solution. However, to make an informed choice, you must understand both sides of the coin.

PART 1: The Pros of Selling to a Professional Home Buyer

1. Speed: The Gift of Time

The most significant advantage of a professional buyer is the timeline. In a traditional sale, you are at the mercy of the buyer's bank. Even after you find a buyer, the "under contract" period usually lasts 30 to 60 days while the bank performs appraisals and inspections. If the buyer's financing falls through at the last minute, you start over at square one.

Professional buyers like Spencer use their own capital. There is no mortgage application to wait on. This allows for a closing in as little as **7 to 10 days**. If you are facing a job relocation, a divorce, or a looming foreclosure, this speed is often the difference between financial recovery and disaster.

2. Selling "As-Is" (No Repairs, No Cleaning)

When you list a house on the MLS (Multiple Listing Service), buyers expect perfection. They will hire inspectors to identify every cracked tile and aging HVAC unit. Usually, the seller is then forced to spend thousands of dollars on repairs just to keep the deal alive.

Professional buyers specialize in "fixer-uppers." Whether the house has termite damage, a leaking roof, or is simply filled with thirty years of "stuff," they don't care. You don't even have to pick up a broom. You take the belongings you want, leave the rest, and walk away.

3. Certainty and Peace of Mind

Real estate deals fall through every day. Sometimes the appraisal comes in too low, or the buyer loses their job, or they simply change their mind during the "due diligence" period.

When you sell to a local professional, the offer is usually firm. As experienced investors, they understand the upfront costs of repairs. Once they make a cash offer, the deal is highly likely to close. This certainty allows you to plan your move and your next chapter with confidence.

4. Zero Commissions and Fees

In a traditional sale, the costs eat away at your equity:

- **6% Agent Commission:** On a \$200,000 house, that's \$12,000 straight out of your pocket.
- **Closing Costs:** Usually 2% to 3% of the sale price.
- **Holding Costs:** Every month the house sits on the market, you are paying taxes, insurance, utilities, and mortgage interest.

When you sell to a buyer like Spencer, there are **no commissions**. Furthermore, Spencer Buys Houses typically covers **all closing costs**. The number you see on the offer is the number you will receive at closing.

PART 2: The Cons of Selling to a Professional Home Buyer

1. The "Investment Discount."

This is the primary trade-off. A professional home buyer is a business. They assume the property risk, pay for all repairs, cover taxes while the house is vacant, and ultimately try to resell it for a profit.

To make the math work, their offer will be lower than the "Full Market Value." If your house is in perfect condition and you have six months to wait for the highest bidder, you will likely net more money by listing it with a traditional agent. Selling to a pro is a trade: you are trading a portion of the equity for **speed, convenience, and certainty.**

2. Lack of "Market Testing."

When you list a house on the open market, you are showing it to thousands of people. In a "hot" market, this can lead to a bidding war. When you sell to a professional buyer, you are dealing with one entity. You won't know whether a random family might have been willing to pay \$5,000 more because they liked the oak tree in the backyard.

3. The Risk of "I-Buyers" vs. Local Buyers

Not all professional buyers are the same. Large corporate "I-Buyers" (huge national companies) often use algorithms to make offers. They may start with a high offer and then "nickel and dime" you with massive service fees after an inspection.

This is why working with a **local** buyer like Spencer is crucial. Local buyers know the Memphis neighborhoods; they have a reputation to uphold in the community, and they provide a personal touch that a corporate algorithm cannot.

PART 3: Is a Professional Buyer Right for You?

Every homeowner's situation is unique. However, over the last 10 years, we have found that a professional cash offer is often the best solution for people in the following scenarios:

- **Inherited Properties:** If you've inherited a house that is hours away or in disrepair, trying to manage a renovation and a sale from a distance is a nightmare. A cash sale allows you to settle the estate quickly.

- **Avoiding Foreclosure:** If you are behind on payments, the clock is ticking. A fast cash sale can pay off the bank and improve your credit score before the auction.
 - **Rental Properties Gone Wrong:** Being a landlord is tough. If you have "tenants from hell" or a vacant house that is being vandalized, a professional buyer can take that headache off your plate—even with the tenants still inside.
 - **Major Life Changes:** Divorce, job loss, or a sudden illness can make the "traditional" 6-month selling process impossible to endure.
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PART 4: The "Spencer Buys Houses" Difference

At Spencer Buys Houses, the philosophy isn't just about buying real estate; it's about **beautifying Tennessee one house at a time**. When a local investor buys a distressed property, they hire local contractors, buy materials from local stores, and eventually provide a renovated, safe home for a new family. It is an investment in the Memphis community.

The Process is Simple:

1. **Contact Us:** Call us or fill out the form on our site.
 2. **The Visit:** We do a quick walkthrough of the property (no cleaning required!).
 3. **The Offer:** We provide a fair, all-cash offer. No pressure, no gimmicks.
 4. **The Closing:** You choose the date. We handle the paperwork, pay the costs, and you get your check.
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Summary: Making the Choice

The decision comes down to your priorities.

- **Choose a Realtor if:** your house is in great shape, you aren't in a rush, and your primary goal is the highest possible sale price, regardless of the time and effort involved.
- **Choose a Local Professional Buyer if you value your time, want to avoid the stress of repairs and showings,** need to move quickly, or the house has issues that would make a traditional sale difficult.

You deserve to know all your options. Don't let a "sticky" real estate situation hold you back from the things you love.

Download Our FREE Guide

We have put together a comprehensive resource to help you navigate these waters. Our guide, "**The Pros & Cons of Selling Your House To A Professional Real Estate Investor,**" provides more detail on the hidden costs of selling and how to vet a buyer to ensure they are legitimate.

[Download our FREE Guide here](#)

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THE HOMEOWNER'S CLEAR-PATH GUIDE

Everything You Need to Know About Selling Your House Without the Stress, Repairs, or Commissions.

Introduction: Why This Guide Matters

Selling a home is one of the most significant transactions you will ever make. For most people in Memphis and the surrounding areas, the "standard" way—listing with an agent—is the only way

they know. But for many, that path is filled with roadblocks: expensive repairs, months of waiting, and the constant stress of strangers walking through your home.

This guide was created by **Spencer Buys Houses** to give you an honest, "under the hood" look at your options. Whether you choose to sell to us, list with an agent, or sell it yourself, we want you to have the facts.

Chapter 1: The Three Ways to Sell

There are three primary ways to sell your property in today's market:

1. **The Traditional Path (Real Estate Agent):** Best for homes in tip-top shape where the seller is not in a rush.
 2. **For Sale By Owner (FSBO):** Ideal for those with a buyer lined up (such as a friend or family member) and looking to save on commission.
 3. **The Professional Cash Buyer:** Best for those who value speed, convenience, and an "as-is" sale.
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Chapter 2: The "Hidden" Costs of a Traditional Sale

Many homeowners look at a high listing price and assume that is the amount they will walk away with. However, the "Retail Price" is rarely the "Net Price."

- **The 6% Commission:** On a \$250,000 home, you immediately lose \$15,000 to agent fees.
- **The Repair List:** Traditional buyers often demand a "repair credit" or ask you to fix the roof, HVAC, or foundation before closing. This can cost \$5,000 to \$20,000+.
- **Holding Costs:** Every month your house sits on the market, you are paying:
 - Mortgage interest
 - Property taxes
 - Insurance
 - Utilities
 - Lawn maintenance
- **Closing Costs:** Usually another 2% to 3% of the sales price.

The Reality: By the time you pay commissions, repairs, and holding costs, you may actually net less than you would with a fast cash offer.

Chapter 3: When a Professional Cash Buyer is the Right Choice

Selling to a local buyer like Spencer Shadrach isn't for everyone. It is specifically designed for people who find themselves in "Sticky Situations":

1. The Distressed Property

If your house needs a new roof, has foundation issues, or has been damaged by fire or water, a traditional buyer's bank will often refuse to lend on it. We buy these houses "as-is."

2. Inherited Homes & Probate

Dealing with the loss of a loved one is hard enough. Managing a house full of belongings and a looming tax bill shouldn't be your second job. We can help you settle the estate in days.

3. Tired Landlords

If you have a rental property with "problem tenants" or a house that has been trashed, we can take it off your hands—even if the tenants are still living there.

4. Relocation or Foreclosure

If the clock is ticking, you don't have six months to wait for a buyer. We can close in as little as 7 days, stopping foreclosure in its tracks or letting you move for your new job on time.

Chapter 4: The Spencer Buys Houses 4-Step Process

We believe in transparency. Here is exactly how our "Cash Offer Program" works:

1. **Discovery:** *You share your property details and goals. We do a quick analysis of the neighborhood.*
 2. **The Walkthrough:** *We see the house. Don't worry about cleaning or repairs—we've seen it all!*
 3. **The Offer:** *We present a fair, all-cash offer. There is zero obligation. If it doesn't work for you, we part as friends.*
 4. **The Win:** *You pick the closing date. We handle the paperwork, pay the closing costs, and you get your cash at a local, reputable title company.*
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Chapter 5: Warning! How to Spot a "Predatory" Buyer

Not all "We Buy Houses" companies are local or honest. Before you sign anything, ask these three questions:

1. **Are you local?** Many "buyers" are actually out-of-state call centers that will sell your contract to someone else. Spencer is local to the Memphis area.
 2. **Can you show me proof of funds?** A real buyer should be able to show they have the cash ready to close.
 3. **Will you pay my closing costs?** Some buyers hide fees in the fine print. At Spencer Buys Houses, we pay your closing costs.
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Final Thoughts: Your Next Step

You have a choice to make. You can spend the next few months fixing, cleaning, and hoping for a buyer—or you can solve your property problem today.

If you want to see what your "As-Is" cash offer looks like, contact us today.

Phone: 901-621-8799 **Website:** www.spencerbuyshouses.com

Special Offer for Guide Readers:

Mention this guide when you call, and we will provide a **Free Property Strategy Session**. Even if you don't sell to us, we will help you map out the best way to get your house sold for the most money in the shortest time.

Spencer Shadrach Owner, Spencer Buys Houses Serving Memphis, Olive Branch, Cordova, and beyond.
